QP CODE: 24900218

FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR

EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024

First Semester

Discipline Specific Core Course - MG1DSCPEJ101 - NEWS REPORTING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A
Multiple Choice Questions
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. d) Reports on events that have just occurred or are currently developing requiring immediate coverage [U] [1]
2. b) Balance the public's need for information against potential harm to individuals [U] [1]
3. b) Immediate events and facts [U] [1]
4. a) Editorial [U] [2]
5. b) To report on key points, themes, and audience reactions [U] [2]
6. b) AFP [U] [2]
7. a) They work independently and are paid per piece [U] [3]
8. c) Uncovering hidden or suppressed information [U] [3]
9. b) They provide personal perspectives and credibility [U] [4]
10. a) Changing the pitch and tone of the voice [U] [4]

PART B
Short Answer Type Questions

Answer any ten questions. Each question carries 3 marks

11. **Hard News:** All event centered news comes in the category of hard news. It is the narration of any event that is reported immediately. It is factual stories with data that is available for analysis. Issues of politics, war, economics and crime are considered as hard news that come on the Front page of the daily. **Example:** A report on a government policy change or a major international conflict.
    Soft News: The other type of news goes beyond the event that has happened. It analyses and interprets in order to arrive at logical conclusions. It generally includes the background or human-interest stories, soft news often do not deal with serious subjects. **Example:** A feature story on a celebrity's new movie or a piece on the latest fashion trends. [U] [1]

12. **Types of Media Bias:**
    - **Bias by omission:** Bias by omission is when the reporter leaves out one side of the argument, restricting the information that the consumer receives.

- **Bias by selection of sources:** Bias by selection of sources occurs when the author includes multiple sources that only have to do with one side. Also, this can occur when the author intentionally leaves out sources that are pertinent to the other side of the story
- **Bias by story selection:** The second type of bias by selection is bias by story selection. This is seen more throughout an entire corporation, rather than through few stories. This occurs when news broadcasters only choose to include stories that support the overall belief of the corporation in their broadcasts.
- **Bias by placement:** This type of bias shows how important a particular story is to the reporter. Editors will choose to poorly place stories that they don't think are as important, or that they don't want to be as easily accessible. This placement is used to downplay their importance and make consumers think they aren't as important.
- **Bias by labeling:** Bias by labeling is a more complicated type of bias mostly used to falsely describe politicians. [U] [1]

13. In some cases, stories may present anonymous or unqualified sources (e.g., sources near the president said..., Royal insiders say...). This may be due to the reporter's commitment to keeping the source's name concealed. In general, however, not to mention the source's name and qualification has the effect of decreasing the credibility of the story. Without knowing the identity of the source, it becomes difficult to verify the information's accuracy and credibility. This can lead to the spread of misinformation or biased reporting. Overdependence on anonymous sources can affect public trust in journalism. Readers and viewers may question the reliability of news stories if they frequently depend on unnamed sources.

[U] [1]

14.

- Access to court documents and proceedings is crucial for investigative journalism.
- Court records are generally public unless sealed by law.
- Rules for accessing court records vary by jurisdiction.
- Sensitive cases may have restrictions to protect privacy.
- Transparency in court records allows public scrutiny of legal proceedings.
- This openness holds judges and attorneys accountable.
- Informed citizens can better engage in civic duties and understand legal processes.

Ways to access:

a. **Visiting the Courthouse:** Journalists can visit the courthouse to access physical records. They should go to the clerk's office and request the documents they need.
b. **Networking with Lawyers:** Building relationships with lawyers can help journalists gain access to court documents and insights into ongoing cases.
c. **National Judicial Data Grid (NJDG):** Provides access to case status information across various courts in India. Journalists can use this platform to track cases and access relevant data.
d. **Court Websites:** Many courts publish judgments, orders, and case details on their official websites. This is a direct way to access public records.

[U] [2]

15. **Three national news agencies:**
    - **THE PRESS TRUST OF INDIA (PTI)** is the largest news agency in India. It was founded on August 27, 1947, and began operations in February 1949. PTI is a non-profit cooperative owned by more than 450 Indian newspapers. It provides news coverage in both English and Hindi and has correspondents in major cities and capitals around the world. PTI is headquartered in New Delhi

    Aveek Sarkar: chairman of PTI

    - **UNITED NEWS OF INDIA (UNI):** The second-largest news agency in India

    Founded on December 19, 1959. It began its commercial operations on March 21, 1961. UNI provides news coverage in multiple languages, including English, Hindi, Urdu, and Kannada. UNI was established to provide a second news agency in India, acting as a corrective to the Press Trust of India (PTI). It was sponsored by eight leading newspapers, including The Hindu, The Times of India, and The Statesman.

    - **Asian News International (ANI):** Founded: 1971 by Prem Prakash**.**

    Services: Provides syndicated multimedia news feeds, including text news, TV programs, and multimedia content. It covers a wide range of topics such as politics, business, sports, entertainment, health, technology, and travel.

    Three international news agencies:
    - **Associated Press (AP):** Founded in 1846 in New York, AP is one of the largest and most respected news agencies globally. It provides news coverage in multiple languages and has a vast network of journalists and bureaus in nearly 120 countries. Operates AP Radio Network and AP Television News (APTN), a global video news agency.
    - **Reuters:** Paul Reuters founded it in 1851.Thomson Reuters Corporation, a multinational media conglomerate, currently owns Reuters with its headquarters in London. Coverage in over 16 languages.
    - **Agence France-Presse (AFP):** A French international news agency headquartered in Paris, France. Founded in 1835 as Havas, it is the world's oldest news agency. Founder: Charles-Louis Havas.

[K] [2]

16. **Reporting on a Speech**

    Audience & Mood: Note the size, composition, and mood of the audience without making subjective comments.

    Speakers: Identify main speakers and anyone making significant points. Know their names and titles beforehand or find out during the event.

    Crowd Size: Estimate the crowd size by counting small groups and scaling up. Be careful of biased estimates from police or organizers.

    Accurate Notes: Take clear and accurate notes, focusing on important points. Use shorthand or a tape recorder or other recording devices if necessary.

    Prepared Speeches: Follow along with provided copies to catch any changes or additions.

    Balanced Reporting: Check outrageous claims and get responses to any accusations.

Finally, make sure that your story contains at least the following details:

- The major point of the speech plus necessary background;
- The time, place and purpose of the meeting;
- Plenty of strong quotes;
- The size and composition of the audience, plus any important people in it;
- Audience reactions if they are significant. [K] [2]

17. It can be said that the role of investigative journalism is not to report the news as it emerges, but rather to find newsworthy stories that are not yet in the public domain. It is not their role to report on news stories of fraud and corruption but rather to try to discover fraudulent and corrupt activities that are hidden from view. They therefore play a watchdog role in society by calling out such illicit activities and bringing them, not only to the attention of the public, but often to the attention of law enforcement and regulatory authorities. This involves pursuing and reporting on malpractices and wrongdoing. Such reporting is all about making public stories that powerful forces would prefer to keep secret. [U] [3]

18. **Stringers** and **liners** play crucial roles in timely news coverage, especially in regions where full-time journalists might not be present.
    - **Stringers** are freelance reporters who gather news on a piecework basis. They often work without the benefits of a full-time position, such as healthcare or job security. Despite the challenges, they provide essential news from remote or less accessible areas. For example, in India, stringers are vital for collecting news from various regions, and they often face risks and low compensation for their work.
    - **Liners**, on the other hand, are typically journalists who work on a more regular basis but might not have a permanent position with a news organization. They often contribute to news stories, providing additional information or context to the main reporting. [E] [3]

19. **Informed Coverage:** Specialized reporters have deep knowledge in their fields, allowing them to provide accurate and comprehensive coverage. They explain complex topics clearly, offering valuable insights and detailed accounts that enrich understanding.

Credibility and Trust: Experts in journalism build trust through their authoritative knowledge on specific subjects like finance, technology, health, and environmental issues. They verify facts and debunk falsehoods, ensuring reliable information amid rising misinformation.

Audience Targeting: Specialized reporting tailors content to specific audience segments, addressing unique concerns and preferences. This approach builds a loyal, engaged community.

Curating Content: Specialized journalists sift through vast information, highlighting key findings that matter most. For example, a medical journalist identifies significant research breakthroughs, helping readers focus on essential information. [An] [3]

20. **<u>Traditional Media:</u>**

Formal Tone: Maintains a formal tone to uphold journalistic standards.
In-Depth Reporting: Provides detailed, well-researched stories.
Structured Format: Follows a structured format like the inverted pyramid style.
Editing Rigor: Undergoes multiple rounds of editing for accuracy.
Longer Pieces: Allows for comprehensive, longer articles.
New Media:
Conversational Tone: Uses an informal, engaging tone.
Brevity and Conciseness: Delivers information quickly for short attention spans.
Multimedia Integration: Includes images, videos, and hyperlinks for a richer experience.
Interactive Elements: Engages readers through comments and shares.
Speed and Agility: Enables real-time updates and immediate responses. [An] [4]

21. Citizen journalism significantly impacts traditional media by blurring the lines between professional journalism and citizen reporting. With the increase of digital technologies and social media, anyone with internet access can report news in real-time. This democratization challenges the control traditional media once had, allowing citizens to influence news agendas based on their interests.

Traditional media organizations have had to adapt by incorporating user-generated content, such as eyewitness videos and accounts, into their reporting. This collaboration enriches news coverage, enhances authenticity, and provides a more comprehensive view of events. Moreover, the shift towards audience-centered journalism emphasizes transparency, accountability, and dialogue, fostering greater trust in news organizations. [U] [4]

22. Technology has revolutionized journalism, transforming the way news is gathered, reported, distributed, and consumed.

- Digital tools and resources have made research, fact-checking, and information presentation more efficient and engaging.
- Digital platforms and social media have become vital channels for news distribution.
- Advances in technology, such as AI and AR, have the potential to further transform the field of journalism.
- Mobile journalism, commonly called “MoJo” (mobile journalism), is a form of journalism where journalists use mobile devices and technology for news gathering, content development and production. Using mobile technology for journalism is on trend now as it has easy production with state-of-the-art technological facilities. Mobile journalism has become an integral and inevitable part of the modern news landscape, enabling journalists to report quickly, efficiently, and in a multimedia-rich format with appropriate visuals to reach audiences of all levels. [A] [4]

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any two questions. Each question carries 15 marks

23. According to Press Council of India, a journalist should maintain follow certain ethical norms such as:

a) Accuracy and fairness: A journalist must inform, and comment on matters of public interest, in a fair, accurate unbiased and decent manner. Inaccuracy and personal remarks should always be avoided.

b) Prepublication Verification: Verification and checking of news before publication is all the more necessary where its publication, and the comments based thereon, can create complications.

c) Caution Against Defamatory Writings: Newspapers should not publish anything which is per se defamatory or libelous against any individual or organization, unless after due care and checking, they have sufficient reason to believe that it is true and that its publication will be for public good.

d) Privacy: Intrusion or invasion on the privacy of individuals is not permissible unless outweighed by genuine overriding public interest. While publishing names or pictures of victims of sex crimes, great caution should be exercised.

e) Eschew Suggestive Guilt: Newspapers should eschew suggestive guilt by association. They should not name or identify the family or relatives or associates of a person convicted or accused of a crime when they are totally innocent and a reference to them is not relevant to the matter reported.

f) Corrections: When any factual error or mistake is detected or confirmed, the newspaper should publish the correction promptly, with due prominence and with an apology or expression of regret in a case of serious lapse. He should also give due weightage to the right of reply and to the letters to the Editor.

g) Communal Reports: Proper verification must be done before publishing reports regarding communal clashes or disputes. The report should not vitiate the situation. Instead, it should aim at soothing the ruffled feelings.

h) Sensational Headings: Sensational headings should be avoided. Headlines should conform to the contents of news stories. They should be clear, unambiguous and authentic.

i) Eschew Vulgarity and Obscenity: Obscene and vulgar items should be done away with as these offend the public's good taste. Also, never glorify violence.

j) Avoid Crass Commercialism: In order to make profits, a newspaper should not throw the ethics and journalistic values to the winds. Instead, it should try to create a suitable equilibrium between objectivity and commercialism.

k) Avoid Caste, Religion or Community Disclosures: In general, a newspaper should, not identify a person with his caste, religion or community.

l) Respect Confidence: If information is received from a source confidentially, the confidence should be respected. [An] [1]

24. **Planning:** Check with the electoral commission on all the details of the coming poll: registration date, start and closing day of the campaign period, election-day specifics (how polling will be organised, timetable for election returns, etc.).

Study the election rules related to: The voting system, electoral laws, and poll watching rules; The use of public opinion surveys (description of the sample, deadline for reporting polling results, etc.); Political advertising; Access to public service media and « fairness and balance » related to public debates and election coverage; National and international poll observation;

o Plan in particular for election night. Organise a fool-proof system of reporting: make sure every major party headquarters will be covered; arrange appointments in advance with political party leaders for election-night comments on results.

o Contact experts and pundits: they will give sound analysis during the election campaign and as soon as the results are public. Election commentators, political scientists, public opinion analysts, should be on standby and attached to your particular media.

Plan technical and operational arrangements: Work with the production managers: they must provide extra airtime or additional pages on Election Day and production deadlines will be later, they should beef up their reporting teams. Plan for emergencies: what do you do if something breaks down on your side (your system crashes, your local journalist cannot contact you; one of your reporters is arrested or wounded, etc.)? Precook the campaign predictable output: prepare profiles of major candidates and close-ups on most electoral districts (economic base, population profile, major problems, and party dominance); carefully draft the format you'll use to report the results. Check your photo, sound and video files on the candidates and the issues of the campaign.

Tools and Resources

1. Fact-Checking Tools
2. Social Media Monitoring
3. Data Analysis Software
4. Multimedia Equipment
5. Communication Tools [A] [2]

25. **Benefits of the Inverted Pyramid Style**

- **Prioritizes Crucial Information**: This style ensures that the most important information is delivered first. The lead contains the who, what, when, where, and why, allowing readers to grasp the essential details quickly.
- **Facilitates Quick Editing**: Editors can easily trim stories from the bottom if space is limited without losing the core information. This makes it highly practical for both print and digital media.

- **Enhances Reader Engagement**: By presenting the key points right away, the inverted pyramid style captures the reader's attention immediately. This is especially important in an era where readers have shorter attention spans.

- **Improves Search Engine Optimization (SEO)**: Online, this style helps with SEO as it aligns with algorithms that prioritize articles where crucial information appears early. It ensures that the content is indexed efficiently, making it more discoverable.

- **Supports Breaking News**: In fast-paced news situations, the inverted pyramid allows for quick dissemination of vital information. It caters to audiences who need immediate updates on ongoing events.

Why It Is Regarded as Efficient:

- **Clarity and Brevity**: The inverted pyramid style ensures that the news is clear and concise, which is critical when communicating urgent or complex issues.

- **Flexibility for Updates**: As new information comes in, updates can be added to the existing article without restructuring the entire piece, maintaining the narrative's integrity.

- **Audience-Centric:** This approach respects the reader's time, delivering the most critical information upfront and allowing them to decide whether to read further for additional details. [U] [3]

26. **Evolution of Photojournalism**

1. **Increased Accessibility**: With the advent of smartphones and social media platforms, anyone can capture and share images instantly. This democratization of photojournalism allows for a wider range of perspectives and stories to be told.

2. **Real-Time Reporting**: Social media enables photojournalists to share images and videos in real-time, providing immediate visual documentation of events as they unfold. This immediacy can enhance the sense of urgency and relevance for viewers.

3. **Broader Reach**: Social media platforms have a global audience, allowing photojournalists to reach people beyond traditional media outlets. This can amplify the impact of their work and raise awareness on a larger scale.

Influence on Public Perception

1. **Emotional Impact**: Visuals have a powerful emotional impact, often evoking stronger reactions than written text. Iconic images, such as the "Tank Man" photograph from the Tiananmen Square protests, can become symbols of larger movements and events.

2. **Authenticity and Trust**: User-generated content and images from citizen journalists can provide a raw, unfiltered view of events, which can enhance the perceived authenticity and trustworthiness of the news.

3. **Engagement and Interaction**: Social media allows for greater interaction between photojournalists and their audience. Viewers can comment, share, and engage with the content, fostering a more participatory form of journalism.

4. **Challenges of Misinformation**: The ease of sharing images on social media also poses challenges, such as the spread of misinformation and the need for rigorous fact-checking to ensure the accuracy of visual content. [An] [4]